

A philosopher in a box.

THESEUS • 2026

Quants solved one layer.

The next layer up is unworked.

Quantitative firms abstract *numerical patterns* out of price data and arbitrage them at scale. The architecture is well understood: data archive, model trainer, fitted parameters, live signal, position.

Above the price layer is the *logic layer* — the patterns inside arguments themselves, the principles that organise how a reader maps a text to a position. No firm has industrialised that layer. The reading is done by hand, the principles never leave the reader's head, and the bet, when it comes, is a one-off.

There is room for one Renaissance up the stack.

Principles are arbitrageable.

The same machine, one level up.

A principle is a logical pattern abstracted from a text — the stable shape underneath an argument, expressible in a sentence or two, applicable to situations the original author never saw.

Theseus reads a curated corpus the way Renaissance reads price tape. The synthesizer is the trainer; the principle is the fitted artefact; the algorithm is the live executor; the conclusion is the position. The bet, when the algorithm fires sharply enough, is the output of the same machine — operating on logic instead of numbers.

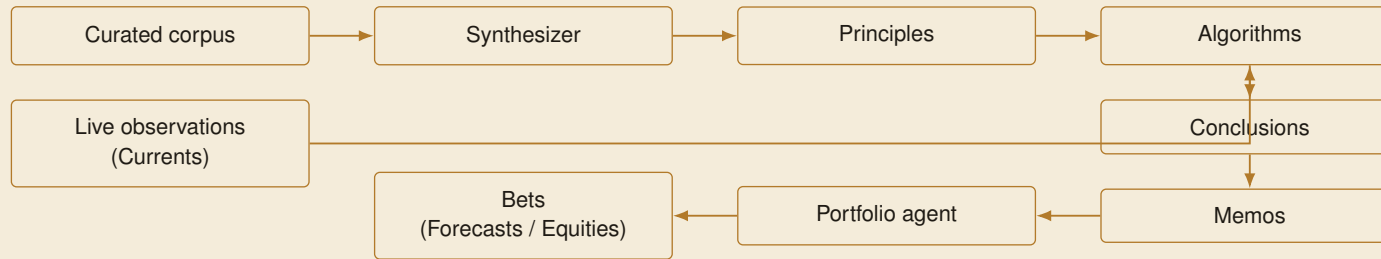
We are the Renaissance Technologies of formal logic.

Inputs → engine → conclusions → bets.



Inputs are the curated corpus and live observations of the world. The synthesizer extracts principles. Conclusions are principles applied to live observations. The bet is the conclusion expressed as a position. Every arrow is recorded, replayable, and gradable.

The Theseus pipeline.



Every named box is a surface on the public site.

The arms-race algorithm.

One principle, one observation, one bet.

Principle invoked

Two-party arms races, when one party signals a credible escalation and the other is institutionally constrained from matching it, converge on a settlement on terms favourable to the unconstrained party — not on the open conflict that surface news coverage predicts.

Live observation

A credible escalation signal from party A; documented institutional constraints on party B (legislative, fiscal, alliance-internal); public commentary still pricing open conflict.

Algorithm output

Conclusion: settlement on A-favourable terms within the horizon, not open conflict.
Confidence band documented; conditions for revision named.

Implied bet

Long the prediction-market contract for settlement-by-date; short the contract for open conflict in the same window. Memo written; portfolio agent sized; bet recorded.

Onion futures.

The quant sees price oscillation. We read why.

Onion futures were banned in 1958 after a corner that ricocheted through the price tape for years. A quant looking at the chart sees amplitude, volatility, a regime change. A reader who has worked through the Senate testimony, the speculators’ position book, and the producers’ political reach sees *the logic of the ban itself* — the principle that produced the price action.

“To write between the lines.”

— Leo Strauss, *Persecution and the Art of Writing* (1952)

The Strauss frame is operational, not decorative. The synthesizer is built to read both the surface argument and the constraint that shaped it. A principle library that holds those constraints predicts the price action that the chart only describes after the fact.

The same stack, one layer up.

LAYER	RENAISSANCE TECH	THESEUS
Input archive	Tick data, fundamentals, alternative data	Curated corpus of texts (memos, papers, talks, filings)
Trainer	Statistical model fitting	Synthesizer (principle extraction)
Fitted artefact	Parameters of an alpha model	Principle (logical pattern, expressible in a sentence)
Live executor	Strategy code on live ticks	Algorithm on live observations
Output	Position	Conclusion → memo → bet
Edge	Proprietary models and execution	Proprietary corpus, principles, and algorithm registry

Polymorphic across where logic can be priced.

The machine is bet-domain-polymorphic. The same principle library, the same algorithm registry, the same portfolio agent — different venues:

- **Equities.** Theses with multi-quarter horizons, executed through the firm's brokerage relationships.
- **Prediction markets.** Discrete questions with a settlement date; the calibration backbone of the system.
- **Advisory.** The same conclusions, sold as judgement to clients who pay for it directly.
- **Scientific.** Hypotheses the principle library predicts; published, falsified, or extended.
- **Private markets (eventually).** Once the calibration record across the public venues is long enough to justify the cycle time.

Team.

Team data is generated from the live founder roster at build time. This placeholder is shown only when no DATABASE_URL is configured.

What’s working.

Numbers pulled at build time. The deck is never stale.

Algorithms active	—
Principles in corpus	—
Memos published	—
Invocations recorded	—
Invocations resolved	—
Calibration	—

Placeholder snapshot. Production builds run `live_snapshot.py` against the live DB.

Snapshot generated by `live_snapshot.py`. If the live DB is unreachable, the build fails loudly rather than ship a stale or fabricated snapshot.

The ask.

Capital	Time horizon
\$_____	_____ months / years
Structure	Use of proceeds
_____	_____

Template. The founder fills the four blanks before each conversation; the rest of the deck is identical across pitches.

What we are not.

Theseus is not a SaaS product. The reasoning architecture is our edge.

A SaaS distribution would force a single workflow on every buyer and would expose the corpus, the principle library, and the algorithm internals to anyone with a credit card. The machine is valuable in proportion to how much of the firm's specific reading has been encoded into it; selling shells of that would commodify the surface and erode the edge.

We invest with the machine. We do not sell access to it. The public surfaces — Currents, Forecasts, Memos, Algorithms, Principles, Knowledge graph — are the firm thinking in public. They are not the product.

Contact.

Firm	theseuscodex.com
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About	theseuscodex.com/about
Memos	theseuscodex.com/memos
Algorithms	theseuscodex.com/algorithms
Three-minute script	docs/pitch/three_minute_script.md

The machine is our edge.